

❏ No multiplayer for you!

Hey! I am having trouble connecting to online games on my laptop. I've tried most games including those that require steam and the ones that don't (liked NFS) but I still can't seem to connect to any online server. I have a stable internet connection and can access the web on my laptop. I have disabled the firewall and uninstalled the antivirus but hard luck, it still doesn't connect. Help! (I can play online games on bluestacks if that's of any help).

Also, I can't seem to start a hotspot with my laptop. I've used tried using the following command:

```
netsh wlan set hostednetwork
mode=allow ssid="myNetwork"
key="1234567890"
```

in cmd but nothing seems to happen and also downloaded some apps to start a hotspot but surprise surprise, those didn't work either. Can the hotspot be fixed with a windows update? If so can you specify which one?

- Here's my configuration:
- Dell Vostro 14 v3446
- 4GB RAM
- Intel Core i3
- Windows 8

—Shivanand Pegu

A Hey Sivanand, Has this been happening since you bought the laptop or did it start after a certain update or after installing any particular software? The easiest way to resolve this would be to reset the network adapter. Open a command and type the following lines.

```
netsh winsock reset catalog
netsh int ipv4 reset
netsh int ipv6 reset
```

If these don't manage to resolve your issue then you might want to perform a



Get a better graphics card first

clean install for the network adapter's drivers to solve the issue.

Also, there is the remote possibility that you might be a victim of a prank.

Check your hosts file and ensure that there are no entries pertaining to Steam.

❏ I need an upgrade!

Hey Digit. My name is Shivashankar and I am an avid PC gamer. Here is my PC specs.

- Windows 7 Professional 64-bit
- Intel Core i5-2320 quad core @ 3 ghz
- 10 GB RAM (2 GB G-Skill, 8 GB Corsair Value Select)
- ASUS nVidia GeForce GT 610 Silent 2 GB dedicated

My PC was an Acer Veriton OEM package bought a few years ago, then later on I changed the other 2 GB Apacer RAM which came with my G-Skill RAM and added the Corsair RAM and added the NVIDIA graphics card. I want to know whether my PC specs are good enough to play games released last year and the year before. The reason I am writing this letter is because I feel that my processor and graphics card is a bit weak. If my PC isn't capable, can you kindly suggest what all upgrades are needed to get my PC to play the aforementioned games in medium to high settings. I have about ₹50k to spend.

—Shivashankar S. Menon

A Hey Shivashankar, Your CPU is fine though it is on the brink of being a bottleneck. What really matters is the graphics card. The GT 610 is an entry level card and it resides at the absolute extreme end of the spectrum, so if you do want to run the latest AAA games, you should focus on upgrading your graphics card. Check out deals sites for a GTX 970, you can get it for as low as ₹22K which leaves ₹28K for the CPU, motherboard and RAM. So you can get a Core i5 6400 for ₹14K and then get an H170 motherboard for ₹9K or less and spend the remaining ₹5K towards getting 8 GB of RAM. If you can sell off your old RAM then you'll be able to get 16 GB of DDR4 RAM.

This configuration should ensure playability of AAA titles for at least 3 years at medium to high settings. **!**



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